As mentioned in the Preface, at the time I had a car pool arrangement with four other officers living in the Satya Marg Chanakyapuri complex to commute to office. We would take turns in our cars and follow a shorter route, which ran alongside Safdarjung airport, crossing over to Tughlak Road via a loop connecting the INA bridge to that road. On 31 October, it was S.C. Mishra's turn to drive us in his car. We had heard the news of Indira Gandhi's assassination earlier that day while at office. She had been shot by Satwant Singh and Beant Singh at about 9.30 that morning.

Around 5.15 p.m., on our way back from office, passing the upscale residential area of Jor Bagh on our left, we were about to take the left turn from Lodhi Road to Tughlak Road towards the INA bridge when we noticed a smart-looking young man in his early twenties walking quickly from the side of the INA bridge. He was thin with sharp features, of wheatish complexion and about 5 foot 10 inches in height. On seeing me in the front seat from a distance, he started running towards us and almost stood in front of our car to stop it. We asked the young man what the problem was. He warned us not to go towards the INA bridge as he was concerned about my safety.

In his typical style, Amar Bhushan, who was sitting in the rear seat, said that in that case we must go via INA bridge only and that he 'would see who was going to touch Mr Sidhu'. When the young man persisted, I told Amar that we should heed his advice. Thanking him for his concern about my personal safety, we took another route via Ashoka Hotel and reached home safely.

At this time, Indira Gandhi's body was still at AIIMS and Rajiv Gandhi, who had returned from his election tour of West Bengal at around 3 p.m., had not yet been administered the oath as prime minister. Some days later I came to know about the reason for the young man's concern about my safety. At the very moment that he had stopped our car, Arjun Das, who had a scooter and car repair workshop on the corner of Lakshmi Bai Nagar market (adjacent to the INA Bridge) and was an associate of Sanjay Gandhi, and later of Rajiv Gandhi, was, with the help of some goons, dragging Sikhs out of their cars and scooters, manhandling them on the INA bridge and